

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient has had a long history of sadness , difficulty making decisions , and hope lessness , which are chronic symptoms .
- Additionally , he has had worsening suicidal ide ations , guilt , and difficulty with energy and concentration over the past 2 weeks , indicating a recent exacerb ation of symptoms .
- These symptoms are consistent with depression , and the chronic ity and recent exacerb ation suggest a possible double depression , which is when someone with a history of depression experiences a major depressive episode .
- Man ia or psychosis would present with different symptoms , such as elevated mood or halluc inations , which are not mentioned .
- An hed onia is the inability to feel pleasure , which is not specifically mentioned but could be inferred from the difficulty with energy and concentration .
- Paran oid personality disorder involves a pervasive distrust and suspicious ness of others , which is not described in the patient 's history .
- Therefore , the most fitting diagnosis is double depression .

- The patient 's history of chronic sadness and recent exacerb ation of symptoms , along with worsening suicidal ide ations , are indicative of double depression .
- The patient 's symptoms align with the criteria for double depression , which is a condition where someone with a history of depression experiences a major depressive episode .
- The other options do not fit the patient 's described symptoms as closely .
- The patient 's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep suggests that they are not experiencing man ia or psychosis .
- The patient 's symptoms are more consistent with depression than with an hed onia or paranoid personality disorder .
- The patient 's symptoms are best described by the statement that they are at risk for double depression .

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< answer >A . The patient is at risk for double depression .</ answer >